

Mikaela Mäensivu

Design Engineer · Technical 2x Venture-Backed AI Founder, Operator, Hustler
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PROFILE

I'm a technical, two-time venture-backed founder, an AI operator, and a hustler, and I design and build the whole product on top of the models. Eight years designing consumer products, with the range to take them into production myself in React and TypeScript, so design-to-code is one job for me, not a handoff. At Winged I designed every surface of an AI agent and wrote most of the code across three production repos. I move fastest at 0 to 1.

CORE SKILLS

Design Engineering	React, TypeScript, Tailwind, and Vite · design-to-code · component libraries, design systems, and tokens · motion and web animation with Motion · Figma into code, owned in production
AI & Agents	Designing for agents: conversation, voice, and trust · multi-agent orchestration and tool calling · agent memory and context · MCP servers · Claude, OpenAI, and open models · prompt design and evals
Build	React and TypeScript · Node.js, Express, and Postgres · Swift and SwiftUI, shipped to the App Store · Twilio SMS and voice · Playwright · Docker and AWS
Product Design	End to end product and UI/UX design, wireframe through shipped UI · typography, layout, hierarchy, and interaction · design systems and component libraries · research and usability testing · prototyping in Figma and in code
Workflow	AI-native development in Claude Code and Codex · MCP servers, plugins, and skills · spec-driven repos · 0 to 1 definition and roadmap · leading small engineering teams

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & CEO · Winged Sep 2025 – Present · San Francisco / Helsinki
Antler-backed AI matchmaking agent. The product is the agent, not the app. 1,600 users in early access across SF and Helsinki.

- **Designed and built every surface of the product**, the app, the marketing site, and the brand and design system underneath, then wrote most of the code across three production repos in React, TypeScript, and Swift to ship it.
- **Designed a product with no app to open**. Instead of a screen, the canvas was a text thread and a phone call. I built one agent with a consistent voice and character across SMS, voice, and iOS.
- **Made an AI product people trust with something intimate**, building the disclosure, consent, and confirmation moments, then shipping the SwiftUI app to the App Store.
- **Built the agent runtime**, a router dispatching across Claude and GPT chosen per task, with tool calling, structured outputs, a memory service, and a Jest suite over agent routing and voice flows.
- **Designed and built Winged Max**, a computer-use agent running over iPhone Mirroring on Mac that operates inside apps never built for automation, architected local-first with human confirmation.

AI, Product & Design Consultant · Architektura Jul 2022 – Sep 2025 · Miami / Remote

- **Took four AI products from idea to launch**: a realtime voice companion, a spoken-language tutor, a multi-model LLM workspace across Mistral, ChatGPT, and Claude, and an AI mental-health coach. Design, interface, and integration all mine.
- Rebuilt major Shopify storefronts around conversion, with measurable gains in experience and revenue, alongside full-funnel growth.

COO, Product & Design · Blocktickets Sep 2022 – Nov 2024 · New York
Mobile-first live-event ticketing built to beat Ticketmaster on price transparency and bot-proof security.

- **Owned the entire product experience**, seat-map builder, season and group ticketing, resale, and a two-click checkout, from specs to shipped pixels.
- **Led a two-person engineering team** and built internal tooling across lead-gen, fundraising, and support.
- **Raised \$600K+** and wrote the pitch decks and investor materials that closed it.
- Head of Brand & Marketing, Visual Design (Sep 2022 – Aug 2023), built the visual identity and the product's design language.

Co-Founder & COO · Supernovas Labs Sep 2021 – Sep 2022 · Helsinki

- **Co-founded a decentralized social network** funded through DeSo's \$50M Octane Fund (a16z, Sequoia, Coinbase Ventures). Owned product, growth, and operations, and grew it to 10K daily active users.

Growth Hacking Lead · Truly Agency Sep 2020 – Sep 2021 · Helsinki

- **Ran weekly growth sprints across the client portfolio**, pairing design and technical execution with strategy across paid and organic.

Talent Acquisition & Stakeholder Management · Goldman Sachs Sep 2017 – Jun 2020 · New York

- **Owned senior stakeholder relationships across three divisions**, translating what they needed into teams that delivered.
- **Built the teams behind Marcus and Apple Card**, Goldman's flagship consumer platforms.

EDUCATION

Rollins College, B.A., English Language & Literature; focal points in Economics, Studio Art, and Political Science. Winter Park, FL
Yale University, The Science of Well-Being, Executive Education. 2020